WEEK 1 - PROJECT PLANNING AND AZURE SETUP

NET731 Friday Practical

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Subscription	Azure for Students
Report Type	Week 1 planning document and screenshot evidence

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1. Business Requirements for CTU Training Solutions

CTU Training Solutions is a tertiary education institution with multiple campuses across South Africa, offering programmes in IT, Engineering and Business-related fields. Because of its size and the number of students and staff across different campuses, CTU needs a cloud environment that is centralised, secure and easy to manage. A solution like Microsoft Azure can help CTU manage resources more efficiently by supporting centralised storage, backup, security and monitoring across all campuses.

CTU also follows a BYOD approach for learners, which means students use their own devices for learning. This increases the need for secure systems that can protect sensitive information while still allowing staff to manage resources properly. Since CTU handles important data such as student records, identification details and sponsor information, it is important for the institution to use a platform with strong security controls, access management and backup capabilities. Azure is suitable for this because it provides a scalable cloud solution that can support CTU's operational needs while improving security, management and reliability.

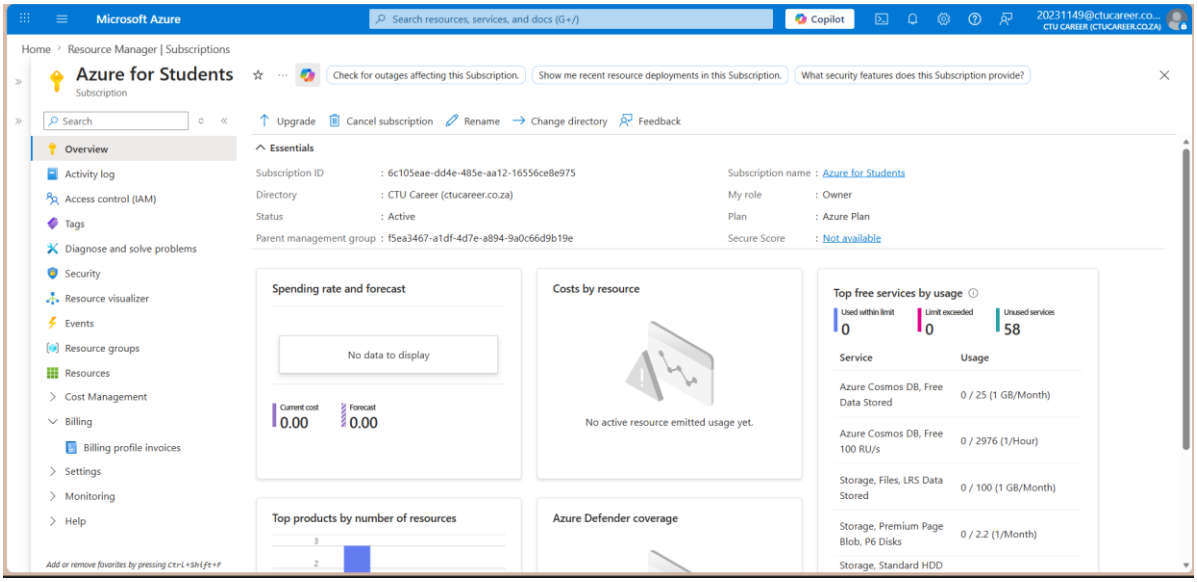
2. Azure Services Required

Azure Service	Purpose	Why It Is Needed
Resource Group	Resource organisation	Keeps all project resources in one managed location.
Virtual Network and Subnets	Networking	Supports the network design required in Week 2.
Virtual Machine (B1s)	Compute	Provides the low-cost server required in Week 3.
Microsoft Entra ID	Identity management	Allows user and group creation in Week 4.
Role-Based Access Control	Authorisation	Controls permissions for users and groups in Week 5.
Storage Account	Data storage	Supports file or blob storage and permission configuration.
Azure Monitor	Monitoring	Enables CPU, disk, and network monitoring later in the project.
Microsoft Defender for Cloud	Security review	Provides recommendations and remediation guidance.
Cost Management and Budgets	Cost control	Helps keep the project within the student credit.

The South Africa North region is the correct region for this setup because it is the region specified in the Week 1 guide and keeps the project aligned with the practical instructions. Using one consistent region from the beginning also makes it easier to manage later resources and maintain a clean project structure.

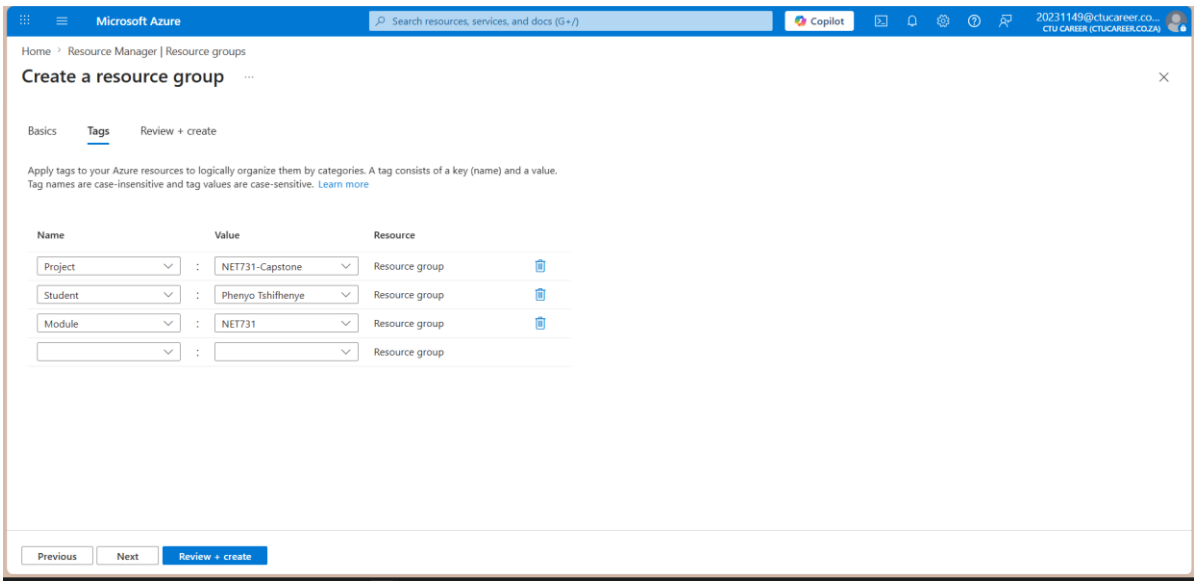
3. Azure for Students Subscription

This screenshot confirms that the Azure for Students subscription is active



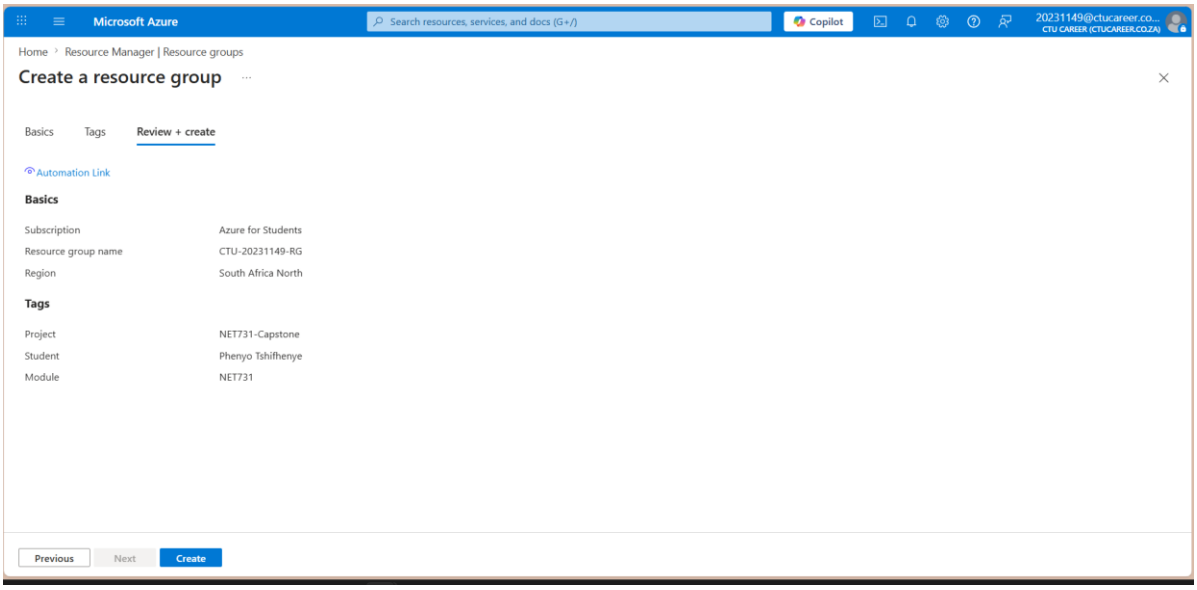
3.2 Resource Group Tag Configuration

This screenshot shows the tag values entered for the resource group.



3.3 Resource Group Review and Create

This screenshot captures the review screen before the resource group is created. It confirms the subscription, resource group name, selected region, and the tag values.



4. Conclusion

Week 1 establishes the foundation for the rest of the Azure capstone. The planning section identifies the business requirements and the main Azure services that will be used in the later weeks.

5. References

CTU Training Solutions (2026) Azure for Students Account Setup Guide. Internal course handout. 6-12 March 2026.

CTU Training Solutions (2026) Diploma in IT in Network Design and Administration: Networks 731 Friday Practical Assessment (FA3). Internal course brief. 6 March 2026.

GitHub Docs (2026) Creating a new repository. Available at: https://docs.github.com/en/repositories/creating-and-managing-repositories/creating-a-new-repository

GitHub Docs (2026) Creating new files. Available at: https://docs.github.com/en/repositories/working-with-files/managing-files/creating-new-files

Microsoft Learn (2026) Manage Azure resource groups by using the Azure portal. Available at: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/azure-resource-manager/management/manage-resource-groups-portal

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